A CHANGE OF ART

Though **Sonakshi Sinha** has a string of releases to look forward to, she is just as excited to see her paintings being publicly exhibited for the first time



Q. Your art is being exhibited for the first time in Mumbai. Does the excitement compare to a Friday release in any way?
I feel like I did when my first film was releasing. Back then, I was stepping into a whole new world and I didn't know what lay ahead for me. It's the same now. This is my first exhibition as an artist and I'm very excited. I hope people appreciate my work. It is something I do from my heart.

Q. You and your twin brothers, Luv and Kussh, had started House of Creativity to bridge the gap between artists and buyers during the pandemic. Was the initiative a success, do you think?
Yes, definitely. We have so many artists from all walks of life wanting to be on the platform. It becomes a way for them to reach out to a lot more people. I'm so happy to be a part of this initiative.

Q. You play the protagonist, Anjali Bhaati, in Reema Kagti's upcoming web show, *Fallen*. Did the series format require a big readjustment for you?
Fallen required me to flex a whole lot of different muscles. I have done films where the male protagonist is a cop, but this is the first time I was playing one myself. Anjali evoked a lot of new feelings in me. Plus, Reema tends to bring out the best in you.

Q. You have sometimes had to suffer discrimination because of your weight. Do you think your forthcoming film, *Double XL*, will help change mindsets?
I think *Double XL* shines light on something that is so obviously wrong in society today. Women are constantly being told to fit a certain mould, to look a certain way, to weigh a certain number. *Double XL* puts all that into perspective. It's a story about two strong, independent, beautiful, 'overweight' women who are getting on with their lives just like anybody else. I hope *Double XL* will make people think about their issues.

–with Shreevatsa Nevatia